

COLE RICHARDS

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UCLA Statistics & Data Science student graduating June 2026, with applied experience in statistical modeling, time-series and geospatial analysis, and full-stack software at an early-stage startup I co-founded. Drawn to data work on the systems that affect real people — health, human behavior, and the physical world. Available part-time now (10–20 hrs/wk) and full-time from June. Relocating to San Diego in August; open to LA or remote in the interim.

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles — B.S. Statistics & Data Science · Sep 2024 – Jun 2026

Relevant coursework: Applied Geostatistics (C173), Computation & Optimization (102B), Design & Analysis of Experiments (141XP), Regression & Data Mining, Probability

Santa Barbara City College — A.A. Mathematics, A.A. Computer Science · Aug 2022 – May 2024

GPA 3.98 · President's Honor Roll

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Core: Python (pandas, NumPy, matplotlib, scikit-learn, statsmodels), R (tidyverse, ggplot2, geoR, gstat), SQL

Geospatial: ArcGIS, QGIS, GeoPandas

Methods: Regression, logistic regression, time-series analysis, spatial interpolation, cross-validation, experimental design

Other: Git, Jupyter, Excel, Supabase

EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & COO — Trident Ember Defense · Aug 2025 – Present

- Built and shipped a full internal operations stack from scratch — CRM, quoter, 3D print queue, 2D mapping tool, customer planner, and marketing site — using Supabase and Mapbox
- Drove client targeting through geospatial risk analysis in QGIS and ArcGIS, layering WUI zones, Fire Hazard Severity Zones, and vegetation data to prioritize outreach across high-risk areas of California
- Closed and executed 3 installations generating \$20K+ in early revenue, including field execution as lead on a 3,400 sq ft residential project with an 8-person crew

Inventory Specialist — UCLA Housing IT · Aug 2024 – Dec 2025

- Replaced a static inventory spreadsheet with a structured logging system, enabling change history, audit trail, and usage trend analysis across thousands of assets
- Managed inventory across 12+ product categories for campus housing operations, supporting device setup, intake, and data accuracy

PROJECTS

Personal Health & Training Load Analysis · Python, pandas, statsmodels, matplotlib

Building a longitudinal analysis of my own Apple Watch and training data, modeling relationships between training load, recovery, sleep, and HR variability across multiple sports (surfing, volleyball, strength training). Methods include time-series decomposition, autocorrelation analysis, and mixed-effects regression for repeated measures. (*in progress*)

California Wildfire Risk Model · Python, GeoPandas, Plotly, Streamlit

Building a ZIP-level wildfire risk score for LA County combining CAL FIRE hazard zones, 30-year fire perimeter history, and vegetation indices. Validating against CA Dept. of Insurance non-renewal rates. Deploying as an interactive Streamlit dashboard. (*in progress*)

Geostatistical Kriging Analysis · R, geoR, gstat

Coursework project (UCLA C173) applying ordinary and universal kriging with variogram fitting and PRESS cross-validation to predict environmental conditions across unsampled locations.

Airbnb Amenity Pricing Analysis · R, tidyverse, glmnet

Built LASSO logistic regression models with phrase-level amenity tokenization to identify which listing features predict above-median pricing, evaluated via AUC with neighborhood-stratified confounding analysis.

Interests: surfing · volleyball coaching · spearfishing · yoga & meditation